

EVOLVESPHERE

Built from the stands, run like a **startup**

A football content funnel built for fans and monetized for brands — no team, no capital, no blueprint. Just the instinct to act, the curiosity to test, and the discipline to repeat what worked.

ROLE

Founder & Growth
Strategist

DURATION

Jul 2022 — Jan
2025

OUTCOME

500K+ views · 5K+ subscribers · ₹10L+
revenue

FORMAT

Growth & Monetization Case Study

— THE START

It started with one rule: don't wait to be ready

Can content, made fast and right, build more trust than big media?

300+

Football videos made — previews, transfer scoops, kits, reactions

500K+

Views generated, with zero media budget behind them

- Before the tools, interns, and brand deals — it was **just a phone**, and matches playing past midnight.
- Every video had a short life span — news moved fast. But each one taught something: **how to ride timing, what headlines spark curiosity.**
- The real lesson: **value doesn't need to be permanent** — just well-timed.

THE STARTING BRIEF

This wasn't about building a personal brand. It was a test of one question — whether fast, well-timed content could earn more trust than big media. It wasn't scalable yet. But it was working.

THE BREAKTHROUGH

From views to value

Small football brands started noticing — custom jerseys, cleat sellers, fanwear stores. Most were bootstrapped. They wouldn't pay for reach. They'd pay for relevance.

- **Created free demos** for brands worth testing, before ever asking for a retainer.
- **Took small retainers** from others once the demo proved the fit.
- **Tracked click performance on every campaign** — even when brands didn't ask for the data.
- Eventually, the dynamic flipped: **brands started replying first.**

The real opportunity wasn't in the videos. **It was in the people watching them.**

— THE ENGINE

Communities, not channels

Telegram and WhatsApp groups that were part content, part commerce — hyper-loyal audiences that clicked when asked and shared when not.

DAILY DROP 01

Insider football transfer news — faster than big media outlets could publish it.

DAILY DROP 02

Score updates with actual tactical context, not just the final result.

DAILY DROP 03

Handpicked deals on jerseys, cleats, and football/F1 jackets.

— WHAT WAS BUILT

Multi-platform distribution across WhatsApp + Telegram

CTR-tracked outbound campaigns for every sponsor

Telegram bots for formatting, analytics & growth hacks

Community cloning — identical content, higher output

Meta Ads used only for growth spikes, never vanity metrics

Intern-led content system with zero brand compromise

Spreadsheets that worked harder than any CMS dashboard

Every part built to scale — for profit, not followers

MY ROLE

No fancy title. Just responsibility.

WHAT I OWNED

- Ran every negotiation, from first DM to signed doc
- Managed operations across content, teams, and analytics
- Built the system, rewrote it when needed, trained it to run
- Handled B2B communication, pitch decks, and onboarding
- Maintained reporting pipelines for every brand partner
- Optimized pricing strategy with brand ROI in mind

HIGHLIGHTS THAT MATTER

- + Closed multiple long-term, recurring brand deals
- + Built communities that converted daily, not just engaged
- + Achieved automation without sacrificing personalization
- + Generated revenue that sustained operations and paid interns
- + Created a plug-and-play system, replicable in other niches

I never stopped thinking like both the fan and the founder.

— WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

Five things no course taught

01 The best-performing content is intentionally imperfect — polish isn't what earns trust.

02 Brands want outcomes, not your aesthetics. Track what they actually pay for.

03 Negotiation isn't persuasion — it's alignment, stated with confidence.

04 Community ≠ audience. A community acts; an audience only views.

05 Growth is about systems. But belief is still the multiplier underneath them.

— WITH WHAT I KNOW NOW

If I were rebuilding it today

Same conviction, sharper instruments.

Build a light front-facing site early, to signal legitimacy before the first pitch.

Turn the backend into a licensable affiliate engine, not a one-off operation.

Launch adjacent verticals — fantasy leagues, lifestyle drops, F1 communities.

Use first-party data to build deeper, tiered monetization — not flat-rate deals.

The instincts wouldn't change. **Only the tooling would catch up.**

EVOLVESPHERE

It wasn't content. It was conviction —
turned into community, then **systemized**
into cashflow.

Gurdev
Thakur

Founder & Growth Strategist,
EvolveSphere

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